

QUARTO A sheet of paper folder in quarters to make eight pages of a book

QUILL A large, stiff feather from the tail or wing of a bird. The tip, or nib, was dipped in ink and used for writing.

REVENGE TRAGEDY A tragic drama in which the hero seeks revenge for a wrong done, often the murder of a relative

ROMANCE A term sometimes used to describe four of Shakespeare's plays—*Cymbeline*, *Pericles*, *The Tempest*, and *A Winter's Tale*—which share fairy-tale plots, noble heroes and heroines, and the theme of great families divided and reunited

RUFF A frilly collar worn by fashionable noblemen and made from starched linen

An orpharion, a type of lute



ROSARY BEAD A Roman Catholic prayer tool. The beads were used to help count the number of prayers being said.

SCRIVENER A professional writer who made a living from transcribing, or copying, books by hand in the days before mechanical printing

SERENADE A piece of evening music, often played outside the house of a woman to win her love

STOCKS A wooden structure used to punish criminals in public. This structure had holes in which the head, hands, and feet were locked, rendering the criminal immobile and subject to the taunts of the public, who also often threw rotten fruit.

TAPESTRY A woven, ornamental fabric, often used for wall hangings or furnishings

Elizabethan pendant



TRAGEDY A type of drama that originated in classical Greece and was very popular during the Renaissance period. A tragedy typically centers on a great hero who falls from power, often to his death, due to a combination of his personal failings and difficult circumstances.

TRAITOR A person who is guilty of betraying their country, their monarch, a cause, or a friend

TREASON Betrayal of or attempting to overthrow one's ruler

TRUCKLE BED A low bed on wheels stored under a larger bed

VERSE Poetry, or a division of a poem

VESTMENT A special robe worn by clergy for religious ceremonies



Selection of goose-feather quills

Quotations

Lines from Shakespeare's plays are still quoted today. Here are some of his most memorable, which you may find relevant to your own life.

HUMAN NATURE

Our doubts are traitors, and make us lose the good we might win by fearing to attempt – Lucio (*Measure for Measure*, Act i, scene 5)

In nature there's no blemish but the mind; none can be called deform'd but the unkind – Antonio (*Twelfth Night*, Act iii, scene 4)

Wisely and slow; they stumble who run fast – Friar Laurence (*Romeo and Juliet*, Act ii, scene 3)

Have more than thou showest; speak less than thou knowest; lend less than thou owest – Fool (*King Lear*, Act i, scene 4)

FRIENDSHIP

I am not of that feather, to shake off my friend when he must need me – Timon (*Timon of Athens*, Act i, scene 1)

They that thrive well take counsel of their friends (*Venus and Adonis*)

Love all, trust a few, do wrong to none – Countess Rossillion (*All's Well That Ends Well*, Act i, scene 1)

LIFE

To be, or not to be: that is the question – Hamlet (*Hamlet*, Act iii, scene 1)

All the world's a stage; and all the men and women merely players – Jaques (*As You Like It*, Act ii, scene 7)

There is nothing either good or bad, but thinking makes it so – Hamlet (*Hamlet*, Act ii, scene 2)

The web of our life is of a mingled yarn, good and ill together – First Lord (*All's Well That Ends Well*, Act iv, scene 3)

DEATH

All that lives must die, passing through nature to eternity – Hamlet (*Hamlet*, Act i, scene 2)



Hamlet ponders the meaning of life and death.

LOVE

The course of true love never did run smooth – Lysander (*A Midsummer Night's Dream*, Act i, scene 1)

Love comforteth like sunshine after rain (*Venus and Adonis*)

Love sought is good, but given unsought is better – Olivia (*Twelfth Night*, Act iii, scene 1)

MUSIC

If music be the food of love, play on – Duke Orsino (*Twelfth Night*, Act i, scene 1)

TRUTH

To thine own self be true; and it must follow, as the night the day, thou cannot then be false to any man – Polonius (*Hamlet*, Act i, scene 3)

It's not enough to speak, but to speak true – Lysander (*A Midsummer Night's Dream*, Act v, scene 1)

TIME

Come what come may; time and the hour runs through the roughest day – Macbeth (*Macbeth*, Act i, scene 3)

REPUTATION

Friends, Romans, countrymen, lend me your ears; I come to bury Caesar, not to praise him. The evil that men do lives after them; the good is oft interred with their bones – Marc Antony (*Julius Caesar*, Act iii, scene 2)

SPELLS

Double, double toil and trouble; fire burn and cauldron bubble – Three witches (*Macbeth*, Act iv, scene 1)